in 1955. The Bandung Conference set the stage for the meeting of nations at Belgrade and the birth of the Non-Aligned Movement.

The architect of independent India's foreign policy, indeed, was Jawaharlal Nehru and the high point of it was reached in 1961 when he stood with Nasser of Egypt and Tito of Yugoslavia to call for nuclear disarmament and peace. The importance of non-alignment and its essence in such a world is best explained from what Nehru had to say about it.

Bandung Declaration

A 10-point "declaration on promotion of world peace and cooperation," incorporating the principles of the United Nations Charter was adopted unanimously:

1. Respect for fundamental human rights and for the purposes and principles of the charter of the United Nations
2. Respect for the sovereignty and territorial integrity of all nations
3. Recognition of the equality of all races and of the equality of all nations large and small
4. Abstention from intervention or interference in the internal affairs of another country
5. Respect for the right of each nation to defend itself, singly or collectively, in conformity with the charter of the United Nations
6. (a) Abstention from the use of arrangements of collective defence to serve any particular interests of the big powers (b) Abstention by any country from exerting pressures on other countries
7. Refraining from acts or threats of aggression or the use of force against the territorial integrity or political independence of any country
8. Settlement of all international disputes by peaceful means, such as negotiation, conciliation, arbitration or judicial settlement as well as other peaceful means of the parties own choice, in conformity with the charter of the United Nations
9. Promotion of mutual interests and cooperation
10. Respect for justice and international obligations.

"So far as all these evil forces of fascism, colonialism and racialism or the nuclear bomb and aggression and suppression are concerned, we stand most emphatically and unequivocally committed against them . . . We are unaligned only in relation to the cold war with its military pacts. We object to all this business of forcing the new nations of Asia and Africa into their cold war machine. Otherwise, we are free to condemn any development which we consider wrong or harmful to the world or ourselves and we use that freedom every time the occasion arises."

Summary

- The partition of the sub-continent into two nation-states, India and Pakistan, and the outbreak of communal violence of unprecedented magnitude in its wake, posing a serious threat to our hard won freedom are discussed in detail.
- Despite the trying time Nehru and Patel had, the problem of law and order and the issue of settling the displaced people who were thrown into the condition of refugees in their own homeland were solved ably.
- The pressing problems that confronted Indian leaders, such as constitution making, integration of princely states with the Indian Union, reorganisation of on some sound and scientific basis and evolving a long lasting foreign policy for the country were handled, despite several odds and challenges, prioritised and tackled to the satisfaction of every section of the society.
- Though many of the Princely states agreed to sign the Instrument of Accession, states like Travancore, Hyderabad, and Kashmir showed defiance but were dealt with sternly.
- India evolved its foreign policy by adopting basic principles. India adhered to the concept of non-alignment to prevent war and promote world peace.

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